

The signal equation of MRI is given by

$$S_c(t) = \int_V s_c(\mathbf{r}) \rho(\mathbf{r}, t) e^{-i\gamma \int_0^t \Delta B(\mathbf{r}, \tau) d\tau} d\mathbf{r} \quad (1)$$

The difference ΔB from the main magnetic field B_0 can be expressed like

$$\Delta B(\mathbf{r}, t) = \Delta B_0(\mathbf{r}) + \sum_{\beta \in \{x, y, z\}} G_\beta^0(t) r_\beta + \sum_{\substack{|l|, |m| \geq 0 \\ \beta \in \{x, y, z\}}} G_\beta^{lm}(t) N_l^m(\mathbf{r}) \quad (2)$$

Where $N_l^m(\mathbf{r})$ are scalar fields describing the non-linear spatial variations of the magnetic field, typically described either by the solid harmonics

$$R_l^m(\mathbf{r}) = \|\mathbf{r}\|^l Y_l^m(\mathbf{r}), \text{ for spherical harmonics } Y_l^m(\mathbf{r}) \quad (3)$$

or by the

In the ideal case, the higher order terms from the harmonics are zero, and only the linear terms $G_\beta^0(t) r_\beta$ remain. However, in practice there are always some higher order terms present, and the ideal gradient fields prescribed are the actual gradient fields realized. The actual gradient waveforms can be modelled well by a convolution of the ideal gradient waveforms with an impulse response function $\alpha(t)$. This can be expressed for all orders of the gradient fields as

$$G_\beta^{lm}(t) = (\alpha_\beta^{lm} * G_\beta^{\text{ideal}})(t) \quad (4)$$

Or if gradient heating is to be taken into account, the impulse response function can be made time-varying as

$$G_\beta^{lm}(t) = (\alpha_\beta^{lm}(t) * G_\beta^{\text{ideal}})(t). \quad (5)$$

While the magnetization $\rho(\mathbf{r}, t)$ is time dependent, we consider readout to be short enough that the only time dependence is due to T_2 decay. Thus, we can express the magnetization as

$$S_c(t) = \int_V s_C(\mathbf{r}) \rho(\mathbf{r}) e^{-t/T_2(\mathbf{r})} e^{-i\gamma \int_0^t \Delta B(\mathbf{r}, \tau) d\tau} d\mathbf{r} \quad (6)$$

With this we can gather all terms that makes the signal equation deviate from a Fourier transform of the static magnetization in the linear gradient fields and form

$$S_c(t) = \int_V s_C(\mathbf{r}) \rho(\mathbf{r}) e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}, t)} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t) \cdot \mathbf{r}} d\mathbf{r} \quad (7)$$

where

$$\Phi(\mathbf{r}, t) = -t/T_2(\mathbf{r}) - i\gamma \int_0^t \Delta B_0(\mathbf{r}) d\tau + \sum_{\substack{|l|, |m| > 0 \\ \beta \in \{x, y, z\}}} N_l^m(\mathbf{r}) \int_0^t G_\beta^{lm}(\tau) d\tau \quad (8)$$

$$\mathbf{k}(t) = \gamma \int_0^t (G_x^0(\tau), G_y^0(\tau), G_z^0(\tau)) d\tau \quad (9)$$

Considering a voxel discretization, we can express the operators as matrices by

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{A}_c)_{kj} &= s_C(\mathbf{r}_j) e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k)} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot \mathbf{r}_j} \\ (\mathbf{A}_c^H)_{ik} &= s_C^*(\mathbf{r}_i) e^{\Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)} e^{i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot \mathbf{r}_i} \\ (\mathbf{A}_c^H \mathbf{A}_c)_{ij} &= \sum_k s_C(\mathbf{r}_j) s_C^*(\mathbf{r}_i) e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i)} \end{aligned}$$

1 Approximations for fast application of the normal operator

To get back a Fourier transform, and to enable the Toeplitz property in $\mathbf{A}_c^H \mathbf{A}_c$. We introduce approximations

$$\exp(\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k)) \approx \sum_{l=0}^L \Omega_{kl} \Upsilon_{jl} \quad (10)$$

This enables us to approximate the forward and backward operators by evaluating L Fourier transforms. We wish to get a similar decomposition for the normal operator. However, a naive application of the above approximation would give us a decomposition with L^2 Fourier transforms, which is infeasible. We thus try to get a decomposition into fewer Fourier terms. We begin with the naive multiplication

$$\exp(\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)) \approx \sum_{l_1=0}^L \sum_{l_2=0}^L (\Omega_{kl_1} \Omega_{kl_2}^*) (\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^*) \quad (11)$$

1.1 Choosing decompositions

1.1.1 The exponential decomposition

Define $A_{ij}^k = \exp(\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)) = g_{jk} g_{ik}^*$. Where we further defined $g_{jk} := \exp(\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k))$. We seek a approximation of A_{ij}^k of the form

$$\hat{A}_{ij}^k = \sum_{p=0}^P \Lambda_{kp} \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^* \quad (12)$$

We use the usual Frobenius norm and seek to minimize the loss

$$\mathcal{L} = \sum_k \|A^k - \hat{A}^k\|_F^2 \quad (13)$$

Using Wirtinger calculus, we can compute the gradient with respect to Θ_{jp} as

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \Theta_{jp}^*} = \sum_{k,i} \left(\sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{ip'}^* - A_{ij}^k \right) \Lambda_{kp}^* \Theta_{ip} \quad (14)$$

and the gradient with respect to Λ_{kp} as

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \Lambda_{kp}^*} = \sum_{j,i} \left(\sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{ip'}^* - A_{ij}^k \right) \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^* \quad (15)$$

If we have orthogonality constraints on Θ_{jp} ,

$$\sum_j \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{jq} = \delta_{pq}, \quad (16)$$

then the gradients simplify.

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \Theta_{jp}^*} &= \sum_{k,i} \left(\sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{ip'}^* - g_{jk} g_{ik}^* \right) \Lambda_{kp}^* \Theta_{ip} \\ &= \sum_k \sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \Lambda_{kp}^* \Theta_{jp'} \left(\sum_i \Theta_{ip'}^* \Theta_{ip} \right) - \sum_k g_{jk} \Lambda_{kp}^* \sum_i g_{ik}^* \Theta_{ip} \\ &= \sum_k \left[|\Lambda_{kp}|^2 \Theta_{jp} - g_{jk} \Lambda_{kp}^* \sum_i g_{ik}^* \Theta_{ip} \right] \end{aligned} \quad (17)$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \Lambda_{kp}^*} &= \sum_{j,i} \left(\sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{ip'}^* - g_{jk} g_{ik}^* \right) \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{ip} \\
&= \sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \left(\sum_{j,i} \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{ip'}^* \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{ip} \right) - \sum_{j,i} g_{jk} g_{ik}^* \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{ip} \\
&= \sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \left(\sum_j \Theta_{jp'} \Theta_{jp}^* \right) \left(\sum_i \Theta_{ip'}^* \Theta_{ip} \right) - \sum_{j,i} g_{jk} g_{ik}^* \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{ip} \\
&= \sum_{p'=0}^P \Lambda_{kp'} \delta_{pp'} - \sum_{j,i} g_{jk} g_{ik}^* \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{ip} \\
&= \Lambda_{kp} - \left(\sum_j g_{jk} \Theta_{jp}^* \right) \left(\sum_i g_{ik}^* \Theta_{ip} \right) \\
&= \Lambda_{kp} - \left| \sum_i g_{ik} \Theta_{ip} \right|^2
\end{aligned} \tag{18}$$

Thus the optimal Λ_{kp} for fixed Θ_{jp} is given by

$$\Lambda_{kp} = \left| \sum_i g_{ik} \Theta_{ip} \right|^2. \tag{19}$$

Thus we arrive at the following alternating optimization scheme:

1. Initialize Θ_{jp} . If not initially orthogonal, orthogonalize.
2. Update $\Lambda_{kp} = \left| \sum_i g_{ik} \Theta_{ip} \right|^2$.
3. Update $\Theta_{jp} = \sum_k \Lambda_{kp} g_{jk} \sum_i g_{ik}^* \Theta_{ip}$, then orthogonalize.
4. Repeat steps 2 and 3 until convergence.

1.1.2 SVD-optimal initialisation of Θ

The alternating scheme above requires an initialisation for Θ_{jp} . We derive the choice of Θ_{jp} that is optimal for minimising the summed normal-operator error $\sum_{i,j} |N_{ij} - \hat{N}_{ij}|^2$, where

$$N_{ij} = \sum_k g_{ik}^* g_{jk}, \quad \hat{N}_{ij} = \sum_p \mu_p \Theta_{ip}^* \Theta_{jp}, \quad \mu_p = \sum_k \Lambda_{kp}. \tag{20}$$

Note the conjugate sits on the i -index in both N_{ij} and $\hat{N}_{ij}$, consistent with the approximation $g_{jk} \approx \sum_p \Theta_{jp}$ (forward model uses Θ_{jp} plain, not conjugated).

Taking the element-wise conjugate of both sides (which does not change $\sum_{i,j} |\cdot|^2$):

$$\sum_{i,j} |N_{ij} - \hat{N}_{ij}|^2 = \sum_{i,j} \left| \sum_k g_{ik} g_{jk}^* - \sum_p \mu_p \Theta_{ip} \Theta_{jp}^* \right|^2. \tag{21}$$

The right-hand side is the Frobenius loss for approximating the matrix $\tilde{N}_{ij} := \sum_k g_{ik} g_{jk}^*$ by the rank- P Hermitian form $\sum_p \mu_p \Theta_{ip} \Theta_{jp}^*$. By the Eckart–Young theorem, the minimiser over orthonormal $\{\Theta_{jp}\}$ is the P leading eigenvectors of $\tilde{N}_{ij}$.

Now observe that $\tilde{N}_{ij} = \sum_k g_{ik} g_{jk}^*$ is exactly the normal operator of the *conjugated* forward model g_{jk}^* . The forward approximation (10) gives

$$g_{jk} \approx \sum_l \Omega_{kl} \Upsilon_{jl}. \tag{22}$$

Conjugating: $g_{jk}^* \approx \sum_l \Omega_{kl}^* \Upsilon_{jl}^*$. The normal operator of this conjugated model is

$$\tilde{N}_{ij} = \sum_k g_{ik} g_{jk}^* \approx \sum_l |\sigma_l|^2 \Upsilon_{il}^* \Upsilon_{jl}, \quad (23)$$

where σ_l are the singular values coming from the Ω_{kl} orthogonality. The eigenvectors of $\tilde{N}_{ij}$ are therefore Υ_{jp} , the same spatial modes already appearing in the decomposition of g_{jk} .

Thus the **optimal initialisation** is

$$\Theta_{jp} = \Upsilon_{jp}, \quad \mu_p = \sigma_p^2. \quad (24)$$

Substituting into the closed-form optimal Λ_{kp} :

$$\begin{aligned} \Lambda_{kp} &= \left| \sum_i g_{ik}^* \Theta_{ip} \right|^2 = \left| \sum_i g_{ik}^* \Upsilon_{ip} \right|^2 \\ &= \left| \sum_i \sum_l \Omega_{kl}^* \Upsilon_{il}^* \Upsilon_{ip} \right|^2 = |\Omega_{kp}^*|^2 = |\Omega_{kp}|^2, \end{aligned} \quad (25)$$

where the last step uses the orthonormality $\sum_i \Upsilon_{il}^* \Upsilon_{ip} = \delta_{lp}$. Thus

$$\Lambda_{kp} = |\Omega_{kp}|^2. \quad (26)$$

The per- k weight Λ_{kp} is the squared magnitude of the k -space coefficient for mode p , which determines the Toeplitz kernel $h_p = \mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Lambda_p)$ for the fast normal-operator application.

In practice g_{jk} is not available in factored form; the optimal Θ_{jp} is obtained via a randomised eigendecomposition of $\tilde{N}_{ij} = \sum_k g_{ik} g_{jk}^*$ (or equivalently of N_{ij} , whose conjugate eigenvectors equal those of $\tilde{N}$), keeping the P eigenvectors with largest eigenvalues.

1.1.3 Decomposition of $\Omega_{kl_1} \Omega_{kl_2}^*$

For each k we have a $L \times L$ hermitian matrix, thus we can extract the $L(L+1)/2$ unique elements to form a $(L(L+1)/2) \times K$ matrix on which we can perform a SVD truncated to the P 'th largest singular values and reform the $L \times L$ matrix to get

$$\Omega_{kl_1} \Omega_{kl_2}^* \approx \sum_{p=0}^P C_{l_1 l_2, p} \Lambda_{kp}. \quad (27)$$

For each p we have a $L \times L$ hermitian matrix, for which we can perform an eigen-decomposition into the rank R approximation as

$$C_{l_1 l_2, p} \approx \sum_{r=0}^R \lambda_{rp} \hat{C}_{l_1 rp} \hat{C}_{l_2 rp}^*. \quad (28)$$

With $R = 1$ in (27) this would correspond to a Canonical Polyadic Decomposition.

Inserting these approximations into the normal operator (11) we get

$$\exp(\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)) \approx \sum_{l_1=0}^L \sum_{l_2=0}^L \sum_{p=0}^P \sum_{r=0}^R \Lambda_{kp} \lambda_{rp} \hat{C}_{l_1 rp} \hat{C}_{l_2 rp}^* \Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^* \quad (29)$$

$$= \sum_{p=0}^P \sum_{r=0}^R \Lambda_{kp} \lambda_{rp} \left(\sum_{l_1=0}^L \hat{C}_{l_1 rp} \Upsilon_{jl_1} \right) \left(\sum_{l_2=0}^L \hat{C}_{l_2 rp} \Upsilon_{il_2} \right)^* \quad (30)$$

$$= \sum_{p=0}^P \sum_{r=0}^R \Lambda_{kp} \lambda_{rp} \Theta_{jrp} \Theta_{irp}^* \quad (31)$$

1.1.4 Decomposition of $\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^*$

Instead of decomposing the temporal factors $\Omega_{kl_1} \Omega_{kl_2}^*$, we may instead seek a decomposition of the spatial factors

$$\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^*. \quad (32)$$

The goal is to obtain an approximation of the form

$$\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^* \approx \sum_{p=0}^P C_{l_1 l_2, p} \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^*, \quad (33)$$

which would reduce the number of Fourier transforms required for application of the normal operator from L^2 to P .

Direct optimization of (33) is infeasible for realistic problem sizes, since the tensors $\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^*$ cannot be explicitly formed or stored. Instead, we construct the decomposition using only matrix-vector products.

We begin by viewing Υ_{jl} as a matrix

$$\Upsilon \in \mathbb{C}^{N \times L}, \quad (34)$$

where N is the number of spatial voxels. We then form the Hermitian operator

$$S_{ji} = \sum_{l=0}^L \Upsilon_{jl} \Upsilon_{il}^*. \quad (35)$$

This operator is never explicitly assembled. Instead, products $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{S}\mathbf{x}$ are evaluated as

$$z_l = \sum_i \Upsilon_{il}^* x_i, \quad (36)$$

$$y_j = \sum_l \Upsilon_{jl} z_l. \quad (37)$$

Thus, application of $\mathbf{S}$ requires only multiplication by Υ and Υ^H .

Using a Krylov subspace eigensolver such as Lanczos or randomized SVD, we compute the leading P eigenvectors of $\mathbf{S}$,

$$\sum_i S_{ji} \Theta_{ip} = \sigma_p^2 \Theta_{jp}, \quad (38)$$

with orthonormality

$$\sum_j \Theta_{jp}^* \Theta_{jq} = \delta_{pq}. \quad (39)$$

The vectors Θ_{jp} span the optimal rank- P subspace in the sense of the Eckart–Young theorem applied to Υ .

Projecting Υ_{jl} onto this basis gives

$$B_{lp} = \sum_j \Theta_{jp}^* \Upsilon_{jl}, \quad (40)$$

such that

$$\Upsilon_{jl} \approx \sum_{p=0}^P \Theta_{jp} B_{lp}. \quad (41)$$

Substituting into $\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^*$ yields

$$\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^* \approx \sum_{p=0}^P \sum_{q=0}^P \Theta_{jp} B_{l_1 p} B_{l_2 q}^* \Theta_{iq}^*. \quad (42)$$

The desired decomposition (33) is obtained by neglecting off-diagonal couplings $p \neq q$, giving

$$\Upsilon_{jl_1} \Upsilon_{il_2}^* \approx \sum_{p=0}^P B_{l_1 p} B_{l_2 p}^* \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^*. \quad (43)$$

We therefore identify

$$C_{l_1 l_2, p} = B_{l_1 p} B_{l_2 p}^*. \quad (44)$$

The quality of the approximation depends on the magnitude of the discarded cross terms $B_{l_1 p} B_{l_2 q}^*$ for $p \neq q$. To reduce these couplings, we may further rotate the basis vectors within the retained subspace. Let

$$\hat{\Theta}_{jp} = \sum_{q=0}^P \Theta_{jq} U_{qp}, \quad (45)$$

where $\mathbf{U} \in \mathbb{C}^{P \times P}$ is unitary. The projected coefficients become

$$\hat{B}_{lp} = \sum_q B_{lq} U_{qp}. \quad (46)$$

The rotation matrix $\mathbf{U}$ may then be chosen to minimize the off-diagonal energy

$$\mathcal{E}(\mathbf{U}) = \sum_l \sum_{p \neq q} |\hat{B}_{lp} \hat{B}_{lq}^*|^2. \quad (47)$$

Since this optimization is performed only over the small $P \times P$ unitary matrix $\mathbf{U}$, it remains computationally feasible even for large imaging problems. The optimization may be performed using Jacobi rotations, Riemannian gradient descent on the unitary group, or approximate joint diagonalization algorithms.

1.2 How to compute interpolants efficiently

Now, to find the approximations, performing the randomized SVD and SVD in these steps is computationally expensive, therefore, one can approach this with a histogram based method. First of all, the off-resonance and off-linear gradient terms only have effects on the signal on the support of the image. Thus, we do these approximations first only on voxels that are within the support. Next we can consider the feature vector

$$\bar{\Psi}(\mathbf{r}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{z}(\mathbf{r}) = \Delta B_0(\mathbf{r}) + 1/T_2(\mathbf{r}) \\ R_0^0(\mathbf{r}) \\ R_1^0(\mathbf{r}) \\ R_1^{-1}(\mathbf{r}) \\ \vdots \end{bmatrix} \quad (48)$$

Now, we can make a histogram of the feature vectors for all voxels in the support, and perform the approximations on the histogram bins instead of on the individual voxels.

Normal Operator via Toeplitz Embedding

Given the approximation (10), the discretised forward operator for coil c is

$$(\mathbf{A}_c \boldsymbol{\rho})_k = \sum_l \Omega_{kl} [\mathbf{F} \text{diag}(\Upsilon_l \odot s_c) \boldsymbol{\rho}]_k, \quad (49)$$

where $\mathbf{F}$ is the NUFFT and $(\Upsilon_l)_j = \Upsilon_{jl}$. The adjoint is

$$(\mathbf{A}_c^H \mathbf{s})_j = s_c^*(\mathbf{r}_j) \sum_l \Upsilon_{jl}^* [\mathbf{F}^H \text{diag}(\Omega_l^*) \mathbf{s}]_j. \quad (50)$$

Toeplitz structure

Define the PSF for k-space weights $w \in \mathbb{C}^K$ as the type-1 NUFFT

$$h_w = \mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(w), \quad (h_w)_n = \sum_k w_k e^{i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot \mathbf{r}_n}. \quad (51)$$

The Toeplitz application uses a zero-padded FFT of size $2N$ in each dimension:

$$[\mathbf{F}^H \text{diag}(w) \mathbf{F} f] = h_w \star f = \text{IFFT}[\hat{H}_w \odot \text{FFT}(f_{\text{pad}})], \quad (52)$$

where $\hat{H}_w = \text{FFT}(h_{w,\text{pad}})$ is precomputed once.

L^2 Toeplitz approach

Using (11) directly:

$$(\mathbf{A}_c^H \mathbf{A}_c \boldsymbol{\rho})_i \approx \sum_{l_1=1}^L \sum_{l_2=1}^L \Upsilon_{il_2}^* (h_{l_1 l_2} \star (\Upsilon_{l_1} \odot s_c \odot \boldsymbol{\rho}))_i, \quad (53)$$

with one kernel per pair:

$$h_{l_1 l_2} = \mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Omega_{l_1} \odot \Omega_{l_2}^*). \quad (54)$$

Setup cost: L^2 type-1 NUFFTs. Application cost per iteration: L^2 Toeplitz multiplications (52).

$P \times R$ Toeplitz approach (reduced)

Inserting (31):

$$(\mathbf{A}_c^H \mathbf{A}_c \boldsymbol{\rho})_i \approx \sum_{p=1}^P \sum_{r=1}^R \Theta_{irp}^* (h_p \star (\Theta_{rp} \odot \boldsymbol{\rho}))_i, \quad (55)$$

where P distinct kernels (one per p):

$$h_p = \mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Lambda_p), \quad (56)$$

and the combined spatial weights:

$$\Theta_{jrp} = s_c(\mathbf{r}_j) \sum_{l=1}^L \hat{C}_{lrp} \Upsilon_{jl}. \quad (57)$$

Setup cost: P type-1 NUFFTs (independent of L). Application cost per iteration: $P \times R$ Toeplitz multiplications. With $R = 1$ this is P multiplications, and if $P \ll L^2$ we achieve a large speedup.

Algorithm (setup)

1. Compute $\Omega \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times L}$, $\Upsilon \in \mathbb{C}^{N_{\text{hist}} \times L}$ from SVD of e^Φ .
2. Form the $\frac{L(L+1)}{2} \times K$ matrix of unique upper-triangular products $\Omega_{kl_1} \Omega_{kl_2}^*$.
3. Truncated SVD of rank $P \Rightarrow \mathbf{\Lambda} \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times P}$, coefficient matrices $\mathbf{C}_p \in \mathbb{C}^{L \times L}$.
4. Rank- R SVD of each $\mathbf{C}_p \Rightarrow \hat{C}_{lrp}$.
5. $\Theta_{jrp} = \sum_l \hat{C}_{lrp} \Upsilon_{jl}$ scattered to full voxel grid.
6. P Toeplitz kernels: $\hat{H}_p = \text{FFT}[\mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Lambda_p)_{\text{pad}}]$.

Normal operator application

$$(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \boldsymbol{\rho})_i = \sum_{p=1}^P \sum_{r=1}^R \Theta_{irp}^* \text{IFFT}[\hat{H}_p \odot \text{FFT}((\Theta_{rp} \odot \boldsymbol{\rho})_{\text{pad}})]_i. \quad (58)$$

2 Non-Hermitian Decomposition and Multi-Coil Normal Operator

2.1 Non-Hermitian Approximation

The hermitian decomposition of the normal-operator phase factor

$$e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)} \approx \sum_{p=0}^P \Lambda_{kp} \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^* \quad (59)$$

constrains the same spatial basis Θ to appear on both the j - and i -index, and forces $\Lambda_{kp} \geq 0$. We generalise by allowing independent spatial functions for each index:

$$e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k) + \Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k)} \approx \sum_{p=0}^P \Lambda_{kp} A_{jp} B_{ip}^*, \quad (60)$$

where $A_{jp}, B_{ip} \in \mathbb{C}$ are independent spatial basis functions and $\Lambda_{kp} \in \mathbb{C}$. The hermitian case is recovered by setting $A = B = \Theta$ and restricting $\Lambda_{kp} \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$. The more general form (60) strictly enlarges the approximation class and can achieve smaller error for the same number of terms P .

2.2 Full Normal Operator with Coil Maps and Coil Covariance

We consider C receive coils with sensitivity maps $s_c(\mathbf{r})$ and noise covariance matrix $\Psi \in \mathbb{C}^{C \times C}$ (positive definite Hermitian). The per-coil forward operator element is

$$(A_c)_{kj} = s_{cj} e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k)} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot \mathbf{r}_j}, \quad (61)$$

and the maximum-likelihood (whitened) normal operator is

$$N_{ij} = \sum_{c, c'} (\Psi^{-1})_{cc'} \sum_k (A_c^H)_{ik} (A_{c'})_{kj} = \sum_{c, c'} (\Psi^{-1})_{cc'} s_{ci}^* s_{c'j} \sum_k e^{\Phi^*(\mathbf{r}_i, t_k) + \Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k)} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i)}. \quad (62)$$

Define the coil correlation factor

$$\Xi_{ij} = \mathbf{s}_i^H \Psi^{-1} \mathbf{s}_j = \sum_{c, c'} (\Psi^{-1})_{cc'} s_{ci}^* s_{c'j}, \quad [\mathbf{s}_j]_c = s_{cj}. \quad (63)$$

Inserting the non-hermitian approximation (60) and defining the Toeplitz kernels

$$h_p(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_k \Lambda_{kp} e^{-i\mathbf{k}(t_k) \cdot \mathbf{r}} = [\mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Lambda_p)](\mathbf{r}), \quad (64)$$

the full normal operator element becomes

$$N_{ij} \approx (\mathbf{s}_i^H \Psi^{-1} \mathbf{s}_j) \sum_p A_{jp} B_{ip}^* h_p(\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i). \quad (65)$$

The Toeplitz convolution structure is preserved because h_p depends only on the difference $\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i$. Note that the kernels h_p are complex-valued when $\Lambda_{kp} \in \mathbb{C}$.

2.3 Operator Application and Whitened Coil Maps

The action of (65) on a vector $\boldsymbol{\rho}$ is

$$(N\boldsymbol{\rho})_i \approx \sum_p B_{ip}^* \sum_{c, c'} (\Psi^{-1})_{cc'} s_{ci}^* \left[h_p \star (s_{c'} \odot A_p \odot \boldsymbol{\rho}) \right]_i. \quad (66)$$

To expose the structure more cleanly, factor $\Psi^{-1} = L^H L$ (e.g. via Cholesky) and define the *whitened coil maps*

$$\tilde{s}_{qj} = [L \mathbf{s}_j]_q, \quad q = 1, \dots, C. \quad (67)$$

Then $\Xi_{ij} = \sum_q \tilde{s}_{qi}^* \tilde{s}_{qj}$ and (66) becomes

$$\boxed{(N\boldsymbol{\rho})_i \approx \sum_p B_{ip}^* \sum_q \tilde{s}_{qi}^* \left[h_p \star (\tilde{s}_q \odot A_p \odot \boldsymbol{\rho}) \right]_i}. \quad (68)$$

The coil covariance enters only through the whitened maps $\tilde{s}_q$. The per-iteration cost is $P \times C$ Toeplitz multiplications, identical in structure to the hermitian case but with the flexibility of using different input (A_p) and output (B_p) spatial modes. If Ψ^{-1} is well-approximated by a rank- Q matrix ($Q < C$), the inner sum truncates to Q virtual coils.

Per-mode algorithm

For each mode $p = 1, \dots, P$:

1. For each whitened coil q : form $v_j^{(q)} = \tilde{s}_{qj} A_{jp} \rho_j$.
2. For each q : Toeplitz-convolve $u_i^{(q)} = [h_p \star v^{(q)}]_i$.
3. Accumulate: $(N\boldsymbol{\rho})_i \leftarrow B_{ip}^* \sum_q \tilde{s}_{qi}^* u_i^{(q)}$.

2.4 Optimal Decomposition: Alternating Optimization

We seek $A \in \mathbb{C}^{N \times P}$, $B \in \mathbb{C}^{N \times P}$, $\Lambda \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times P}$ minimising

$$\mathcal{L} = \sum_{i,j,k} \left| g_{jk} g_{ik}^* - \sum_{p=0}^P \Lambda_{kp} A_{jp} B_{ip}^* \right|^2, \quad (69)$$

where $g_{jk} = e^{\Phi(\mathbf{r}_j, t_k)}$. We impose orthonormality $A^H A = I_P$ and $B^H B = I_P$ throughout.

Update for Λ (fixed A, B)

Define the projected temporal coefficients

$$f_{kp} = \sum_j g_{jk} \overline{A_{jp}}, \quad b_{kp} = \sum_i g_{ik}^* B_{ip}. \quad (70)$$

In matrix notation, $\mathbf{F} = G^T \overline{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times P}$ and $\mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}} = \overline{G}^T B \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times P}$, where $G_{jk} = g_{jk}$.

Setting $\partial \mathcal{L} / \partial \Lambda_{kp}^* = 0$ under orthonormality $B^H B = I$ gives the closed-form update

$$\Lambda_{kp} = f_{kp} b_{kp}, \quad \text{i.e.,} \quad \mathbf{\Lambda} = \mathbf{F} \odot \mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}}. \quad (71)$$

Compare with the hermitian case $\Lambda_{kp} = |\sum_j g_{jk} \Theta_{jp}^*|^2$: the non-hermitian weights are the product of two independent projections, so $\Lambda_{kp} \in \mathbb{C}$ in general.

Update for A (fixed B, Λ)

Setting $\partial \mathcal{L} / \partial \overline{A_{jp}} = 0$ under $B^H B = I$ gives

$$A_{jp} \leftarrow \sum_k g_{jk} \overline{\Lambda_{kp}} b_{kp}, \quad \text{i.e.,} \quad A_{\cdot p} \leftarrow G(\overline{\Lambda_{\cdot p}} \odot (\mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}})_{\cdot p}), \quad (72)$$

followed by orthogonalisation of A .

Update for B (fixed A, Λ)

Setting $\partial\mathcal{L}/\partial B_{ip} = 0$ under $A^H A = I$ gives

$$B_{ip} \leftarrow \sum_k g_{ik} \Lambda_{kp} \overline{f_{kp}}, \quad \text{i.e.,} \quad B_{\cdot p} \leftarrow G(\Lambda_{\cdot p} \odot \overline{(\mathbf{F}_{\cdot p})}), \quad (73)$$

followed by orthogonalisation of B . Note $\overline{f_{kp}} = [\overline{G}^T A]_{kp}$, so $B_{\cdot p} = G(\Lambda_{\cdot p} \odot (\overline{G}^T A)_{\cdot p})$.

Algorithm

1. Compute the SVD $G = U\Sigma V^H$ and initialise $A = B = U_P$ (top- P left singular vectors). Orthogonality holds by construction.
2. Compute $\mathbf{F} = G^T \overline{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}} = \overline{G}^T B$.
3. Update $\Lambda = \mathbf{F} \odot \mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}}$.
4. Update $A_{\cdot p} \leftarrow G(\overline{\Lambda_{\cdot p}} \odot (\mathbf{B}_{\text{proj}})_{\cdot p})$ for each p ; orthogonalise A .
5. Update $B_{\cdot p} \leftarrow G(\Lambda_{\cdot p} \odot (\overline{G}^T A)_{\cdot p})$ for each p ; orthogonalise B .
6. Repeat steps 2–5 until $\mathcal{L}$ converges.

Optimal SVD initialisation

The full L^2 expansion of the target reads

$$g_{jk} g_{ik}^* = \sum_{l_1=1}^L \sum_{l_2=1}^L \sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2} U_{jl_1} U_{il_2}^* V_{kl_1}^* V_{kl_2}. \quad (74)$$

Each pair (l_1, l_2) contributes a term of magnitude $\sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2}$. The hermitian initialisation $A = B = U_P$ implicitly retains only the P diagonal pairs $(1, 1), (2, 2), \dots, (P, P)$, with contributions $\sigma_1^2, \sigma_2^2, \dots, \sigma_P^2$. However, the off-diagonal pair (l_1, l_2) with $l_1 \neq l_2$ contributes $\sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2}$, which exceeds the diagonal contribution σ_P^2 of the last retained term whenever $\sigma_P < \sqrt{\sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2}}$. For a fast-decaying spectrum this condition holds for many off-diagonal pairs, so the hermitian initialisation is far from optimal.

The better strategy is to rank all L^2 pairs by $\sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2}$ and retain the top P :

$$A_{\cdot p} = U_{\cdot l_1(p)}, \quad B_{\cdot p} = U_{\cdot l_2(p)}, \quad \Lambda_{kp} = \sigma_{l_1(p)} \sigma_{l_2(p)} V_{k, l_1(p)}^* V_{k, l_2(p)}, \quad (75)$$

where $(l_1(p), l_2(p))$ denotes the p -th pair in descending order of $\sigma_{l_1} \sigma_{l_2}$. Since the top- P pairs may share repeated column indices (e.g. $U_{\cdot 1}$ appears in $(1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), \dots$), the columns of A and B as constructed above are generally not orthonormal. The initialisation procedure is therefore:

1. Set A, B, Λ as in (75).
2. Orthogonalise A and B independently (e.g. via QR or Gram–Schmidt).
3. Recompute Λ via (71) to restore consistency.

The hermitian initialisation is recovered as the special case in which only diagonal pairs (l, l) are selected, giving $A = B = U_P$ and $\Lambda_{kp} = \sigma_p^2 |V_{kp}|^2 = |\Omega_{kp}|^2$.

2.5 Comparison Summary

	Hermitian	Non-Hermitian
Decomposition	$\sum_p \Lambda_{kp} \Theta_{jp} \Theta_{ip}^*$	$\sum_p \Lambda_{kp} A_{jp} B_{ip}^*$
Λ_{kp}	real, ≥ 0	complex
Input spatial weight	$\Theta_p \odot \tilde{s}_q$	$A_p \odot \tilde{s}_q$
Output spatial weight	$\Theta_p^* \odot \tilde{s}_q^*$	$B_p^* \odot \tilde{s}_q^*$
Toeplitz kernel	$\mathbf{F}_{\text{adj}}(\Lambda_{\cdot p})$, real Λ	same, complex Λ
Cost per iteration	$P \times C$ Toeplitz	$P \times C$ Toeplitz